Seller Motivation Map

Park: _____ **Seller:** _____ **Date:** _____

Part B: First contact.

Takes in: the first call.

Hands to: AS-07 (structure the offer), AS-22 (the seller note).

Every seller has a price. Almost no seller is selling because of the price. They are selling because of a situation, and the situation decides which structure wins. This map gives you the six situations you will meet, what each one needs, and the structures that fit. Nothing here claims what any real seller does. It is a discovery sheet: you fill it in from the first call, not from assumptions.

1. The six seller types: listen, do not label

Type	Signals you hear	What they need	Structures that win
Estate	"Probate", heirs, "just settle this"	Clean break, certainty, no management	Cash close, as-is, fast timeline
Burnout	"I'm done", tired of the 2 a.m. calls	Out of operations, no callbacks	Seller note, no management role, quick close
Health	Doctor's orders, "can't do this anymore"	Certainty, no stress, family unburdened	Simple structure, attorney-handled, no post-close role
Tax	"My CPA says", 1031 exchange	Timing, exchange mechanics	Delayed close, installment note, CPA coordinates
Family conflict	Siblings disagree, "we can't agree"	One number everyone signs	Single price, split proceeds, neutral escrow
Tired of tenants	Evictions, complaints about residents	The headaches gone	Quick close, buyer takes delinquency risk

On "tired of tenants": ask about conduct and payment history only, never protected characteristics. The guardrail follows you into every seller call.

2. First-call emphasis: the first call maps, it does not negotiate

- [ ] Ask why they are selling before you discuss price. "What would a good outcome look like for you?"
- [ ] Write down their words, not your translation.
- [ ] Never present a structure on the first call. Map first, structure later.
- [ ] End the call with: "If we could solve [their need], would the price be flexible?" Then stop talking.

Front continues on page 2: the structures table, and how the filled map feeds the offer and the note.

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3. Structures that win, matched to needs

They need	Structure that fits	Why it wins
Clean break, fast	Cash close, as-is	Certainty beats the last dollar
Out of operations	Seller note, no management role	Income without the headaches
Certainty, no stress	Simple contract, attorney-handled	Nothing to manage after signing
Timing (tax)	Delayed close, installment note	Fits the exchange window
Everyone signs	One price, split proceeds, neutral escrow	No family negotiation after close
Headaches gone	Quick close, buyer takes delinquency	The problem leaves with the keys

Have your attorney review every structure. This map teaches the vocabulary, not the law.

4. From map to offer

The filled map feeds two tools: the seller-needs box in the Offer Term-Sheet Builder (AS-07) and the fear list in the Seller Note Anatomy (AS-22). A structure proposed without the map is a guess. A structure built from the map is an answer.

Seller type (from their words): _____ **Their need, in their words:** _____

Structure that fits this need: _____

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Worked example: Maple Bend Estates (fictional)

Fictional seller, fictional first call. Seeds: ask $1,650,000. Buyer ceiling = the Pact walk price: 76,470 / 0.08 = $955,875. Gap to the ask: 1,650,000 - 955,875 = $694,125. The call notes below are invented to show the method.

The filled map

Type signals: burnout plus health. "Owned it 22 years. I'm done." Recent surgery. Kids do not want the park. Their words: "I don't want another 2 a.m. call about the well."

What they need: out of operations, certainty, no post-close involvement. What they did not ask for: the last dollar.

The structure that fits

Price $925,000, the target (under the $955,875 ceiling). Seller note $150,000 at 6% interest-only (income without headaches, see AS-22). Bank debt $508,750. Buyer cash $266,250. Check: 150,000 + 508,750 + 266,250 = 925,000.

Why it wins for this seller: monthly note income, no management, clean break, close on their timeline.

Terms can buy certainty and a clean exit. They cannot bridge $694,125. If what this seller needs is the ask, the buyer walks and logs it in AS-25.

First-call discipline held: no structure was presented on the call. The map was filled, the call ended, the structure was built the next day.

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The Doctrine

The belief this map shatters is that the seller's ask is a price. The ask is a number wrapped around a situation. Two sellers with the same ask want different deals: one wants out by Christmas, the other wants monthly income without tenants. The buyer who negotiates the number fights the wrong war. The buyer who maps the need writes the structure that wins, often at a lower price, because certainty and fit beat the last dollar. The one rule: never propose a structure until the map is filled from the seller's own words, on the first call, before price is discussed. The rite of passage is the first call where you stop selling yourself and start mapping, and the seller tells you the real reason.

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